



Questrip

Hifi prototype & Heuristic Evaluation

- team 8 -

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Our team



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* VALUE PROPOSITION

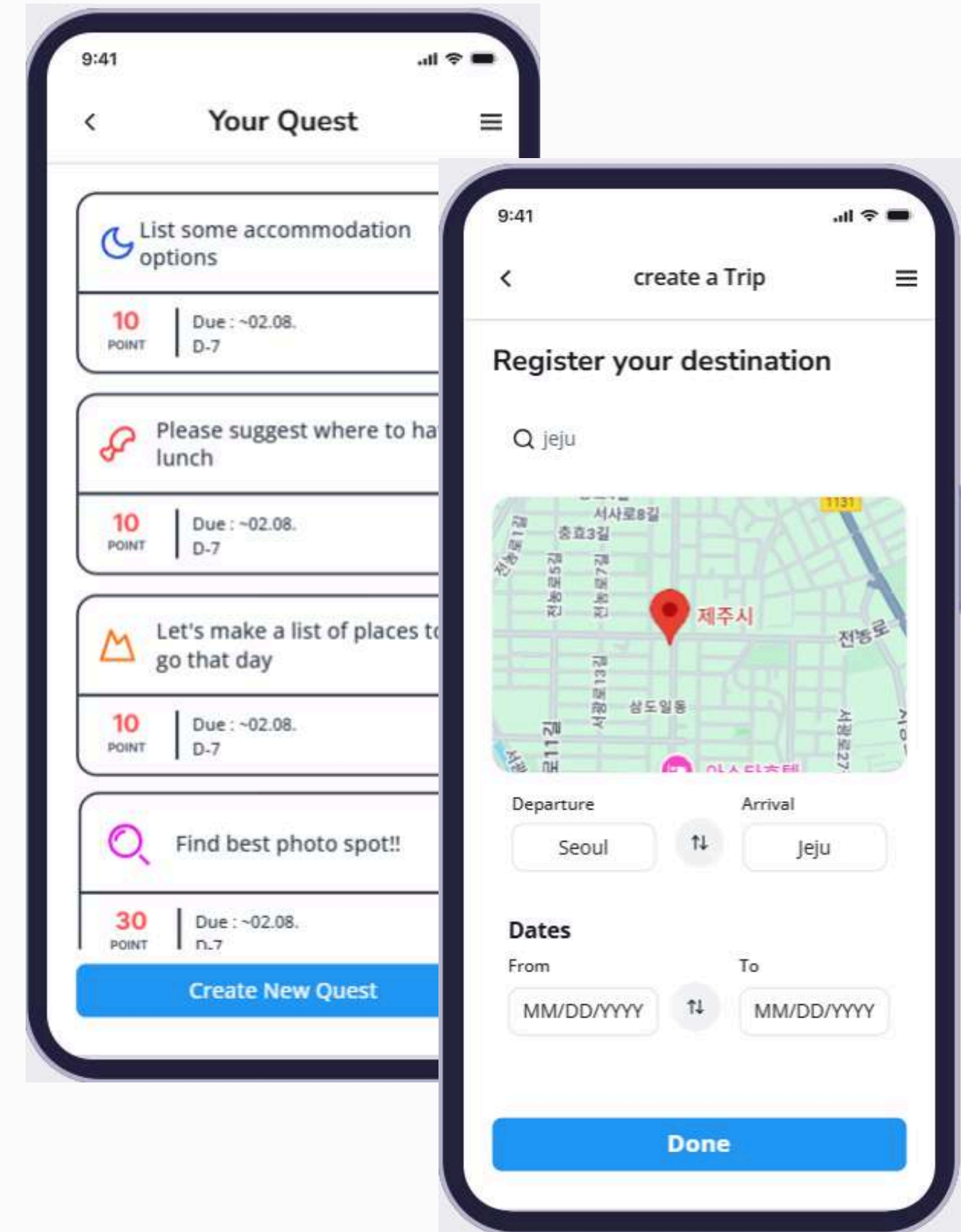
from trip to game

* THE PROBLEM

Travel planning often causes stress due to information overload and scattered opinions. People need a fair, simple, and collaborative way to make decisions together.

* THE SOLUTION

Questrip is a quest-based collaborative travel-planning app designed to reduce stress. It transforms trip preparation into an enjoyable, gamified process using quests and voting. Users contribute options, vote anonymously, and receive rewards that increase engagement.



* Contents

1. Summary of Results
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-simple task
3. Heuristic Evaluation Results
-moderate task
4. Heuristic Evaluation Results
-complex task
5. More Refined Prototype

* SUMMARY OF RESULTS



SUMMARY OF RESULTS

SIMPLE TASK

In simple tasks, inconsistent color usage caused confusion about system status and decoration. The absence of basic navigation options reduced user control and freedom. A structured color system and global navigation were introduced to improve usability.

COMPLEX TASK

The review workflow did not match real-world mental models, causing confusion. Users lacked immediate reward feedback and the ability to edit submitted reviews. The design was refined by adding contextual flows, real-time rewards, and edit functionality.

MODERATE TASK

Users were confused by unclear system feedback, especially regarding submission order and rewards. The voting process and its timing were not visible, increasing uncertainty. Clear messages and progress indicators were added to improve system transparency.

MORE REFINED PROTOTYPE

A My Page and Shop were added to clearly display and use collected rewards. Help icons and guides were introduced to support first-time users. A unified logo and layout were applied to ensure visual and structural consistency.

* HEURISTIC EVALUATION - SIMPLE TASK



ISSUE

* CONSISTENCY AND STANDARDS

Green tape, black pen, and red pen are used randomly. It is difficult to distinguish which color represents the system status versus mere decoration.

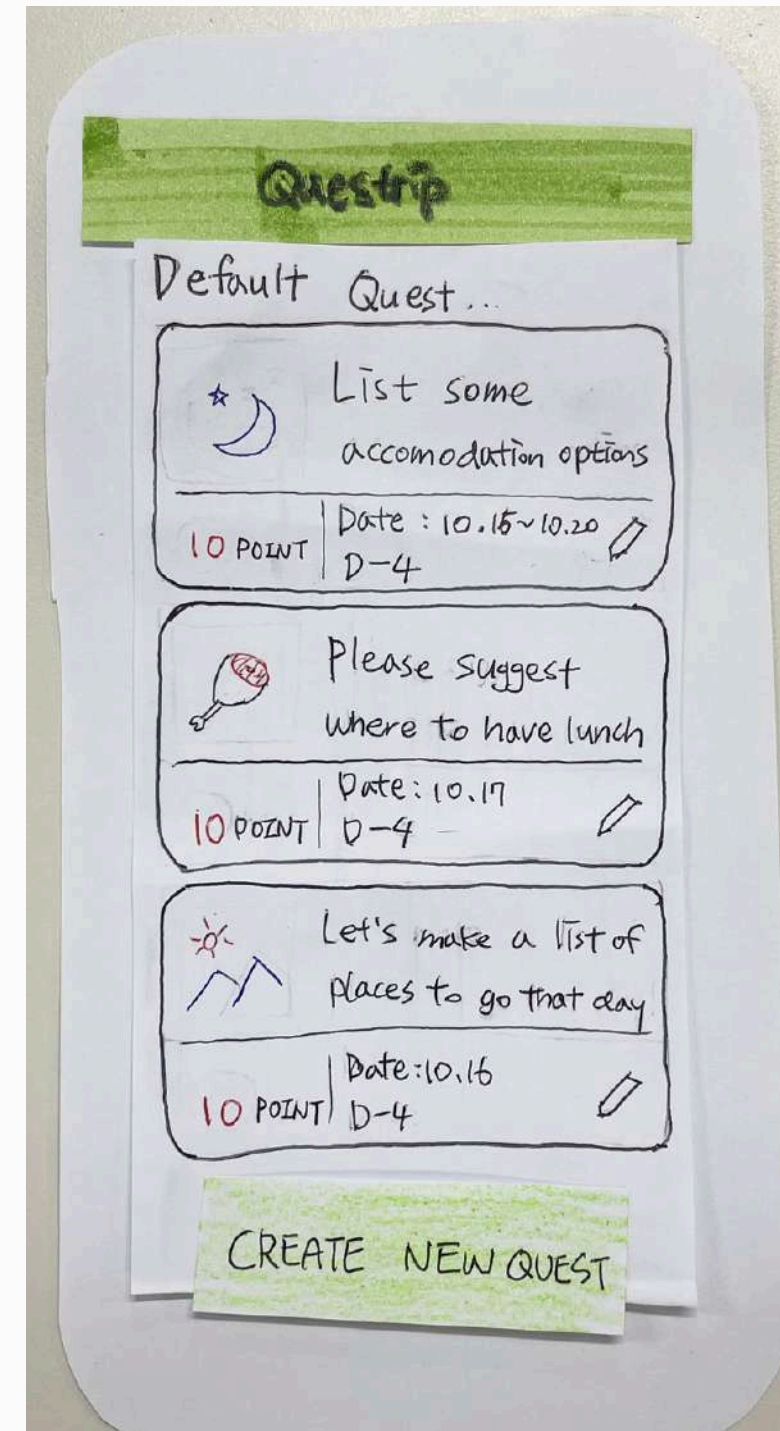
* USER CONTROL AND FREEDOM

There are no 'Back' or 'Menu' buttons. Users are trapped on the screen with no clear way to exit or navigate elsewhere.

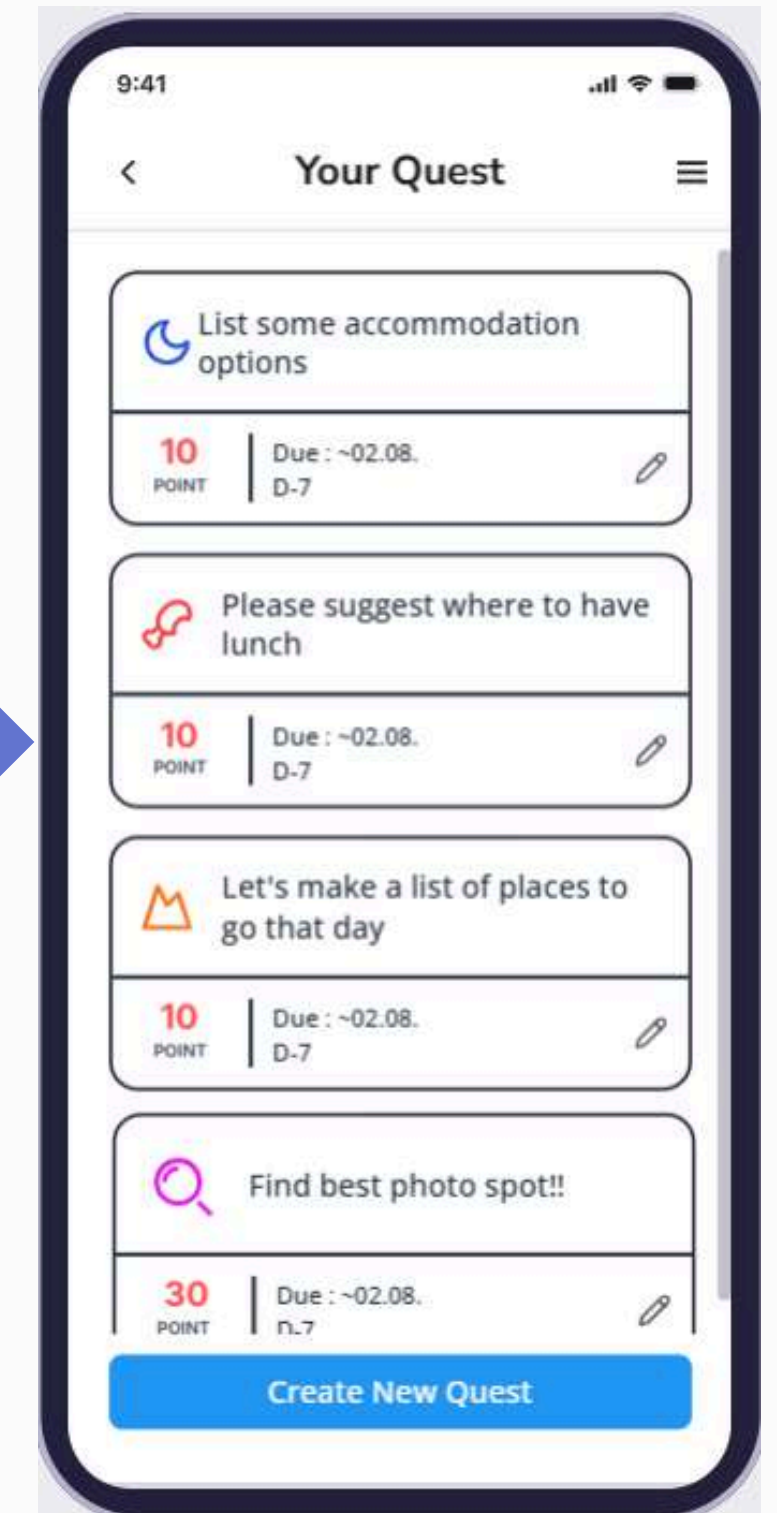
* AESTHETIC AND MINIMALIST DESIGN

The simultaneous use of strong Red (Points), Orange (Icons), and Blue (CTA) creates visual noise, making the interface look busy and distracting.

Before



After



FIX

* SYSTEMATIC COLOR SYSTEM

Established a clear hierarchy: Blue for the main CTA button, Red/Orange for emphasis, and Black/Gray for text. This creates a consistent visual language.

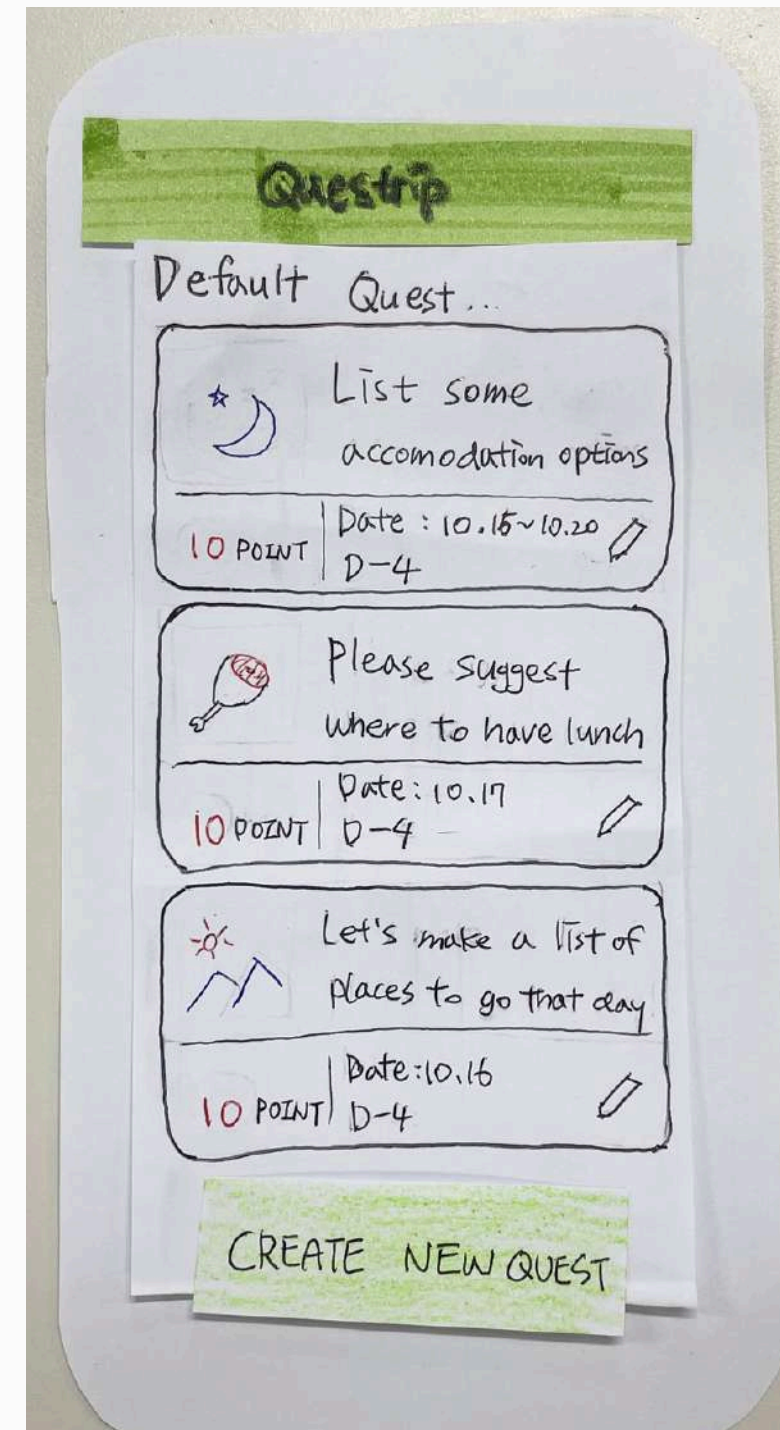
* CONTROL GAINED

A top navigation bar was added with a 'Back' button (<) and 'Hamburger Menu' (=), giving users the freedom to exit or explore the app.

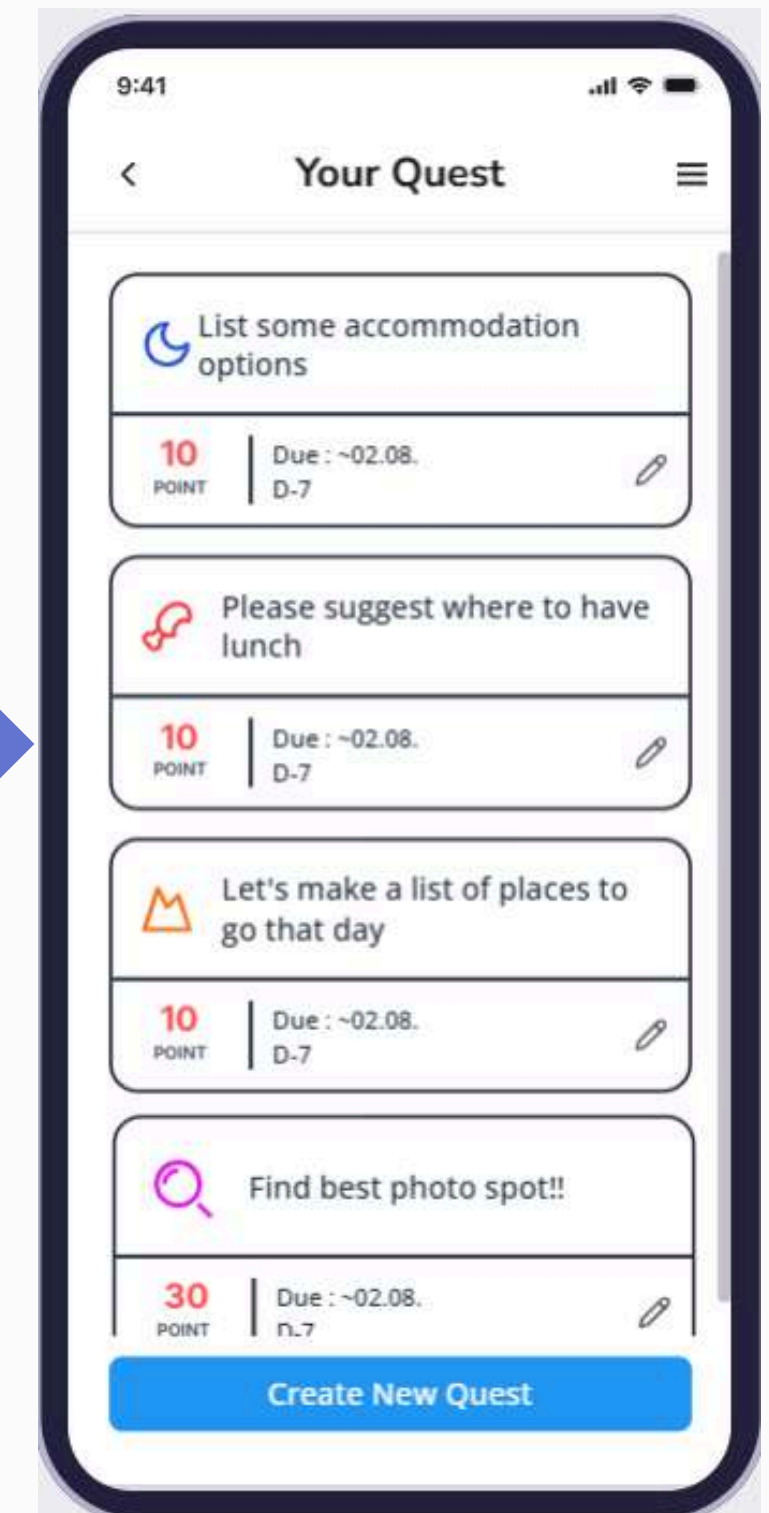
* COLOR REDUCTION

Refine the palette by using one primary color (e.g., Blue) for actions and using neutral tones (Gray) for icons. Use Red only for urgent alerts to minimize cognitive load.

Before



After



* CONSISTENCY AND STANDARDS

In a travel context, "From" and "To" typically correspond to locations (Origin/Destination) in the real world. Using these labels for dates creates a mismatch between the system and the user's mental model.

* RECOGNITION RATHER THAN RECALL

The verb labels "Depart" and "Return" are ambiguous, making it difficult for users to immediately recognize whether to input a time or a location. This increases the user's cognitive load.

* fix

The labels were changed to clear nouns, 'Departure' and 'Arrival,' to align with the user's mental model. The fields also clearly presented the 'MM/DD/YYYY' placeholder to guide users to input the correct date format.

Before

A hand-drawn prototype of a travel app interface on a piece of paper. At the top, there's a green header with the text "Questrip". Below it, the instruction "Register your destination" is written. A search bar contains the text "Jeju Island". Below the search bar is a hand-drawn map of Jeju Island with a red pin and the label "Jeju". Below the map, there are two input fields: "From" with the date "10/15" and "To" with the date "10/20". Below these, there are two more input fields: "Depart" with the location "Seoul" and "Return" with the location "Jeju". At the bottom, there are two buttons labeled "back" and "Next".

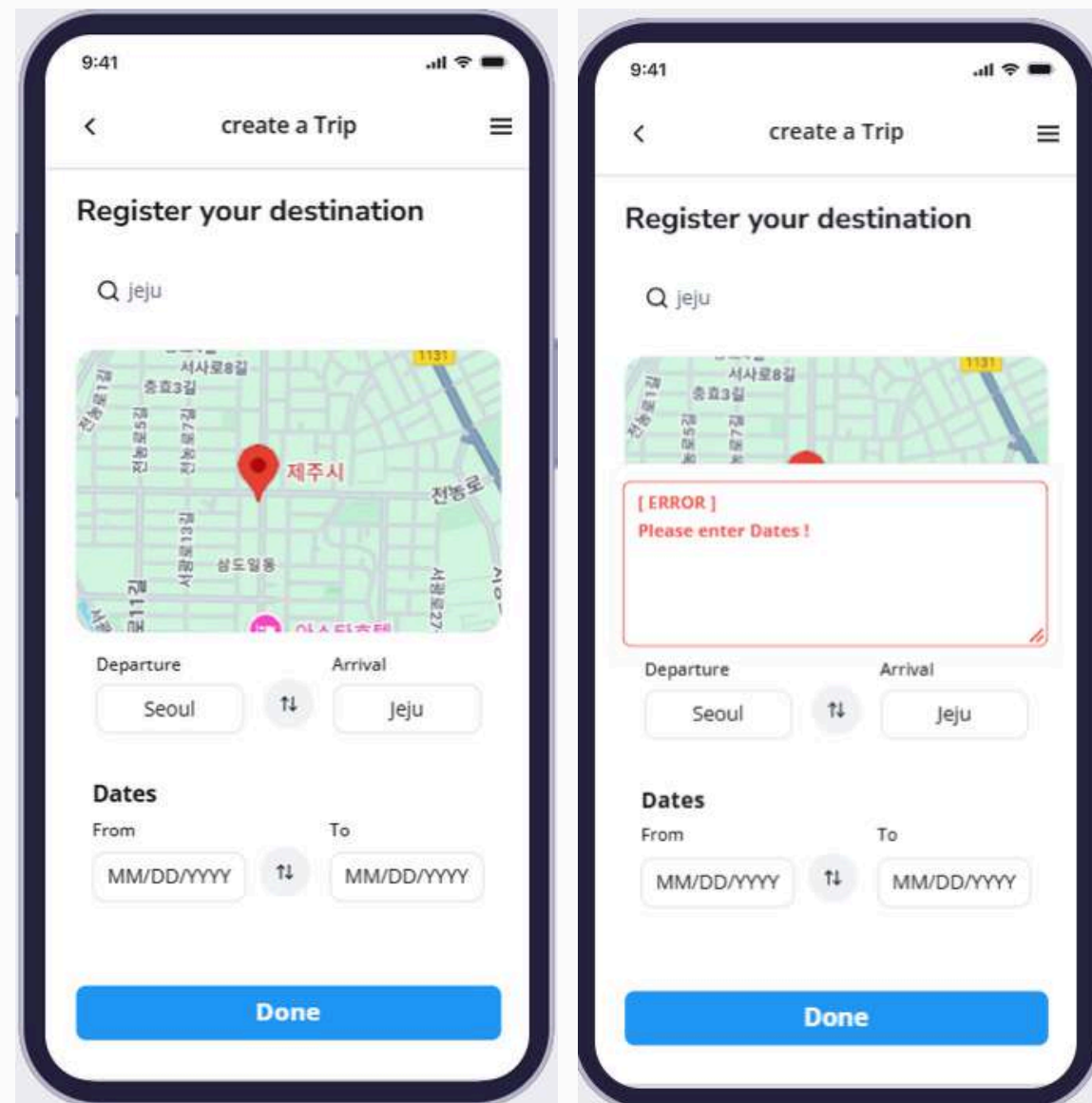
After

A digital mockup of the travel app interface on a smartphone. The status bar at the top shows the time "9:41" and battery level. The app title "create a Trip" is at the top. Below it, the instruction "Register your destination" is displayed. A search bar contains the text "jeju". Below the search bar is a map showing a location in Jeju City with a red pin. Below the map, there are two input fields: "Departure" with the location "Seoul" and "Arrival" with the location "Jeju". Below these, there are two more input fields: "Dates" with the placeholder "MM/DD/YYYY" and "To" with the placeholder "MM/DD/YYYY". At the bottom, there is a blue button labeled "Done".

* BEFORE: NO POPUP HELP USERS RECOGNIZE, DIAGNOSE, AND RECOVER FROM ERRORS

Without any message, the user has to guess what is wrong. They might randomly edit fields hoping it works.

After – Added Popup



* fix

The popup explicitly states "[ERROR] Please enter Dates!", telling the user exactly what went wrong so they can fix it.

* HEURISTIC EVALUATION - MODERATE TASK



* VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS

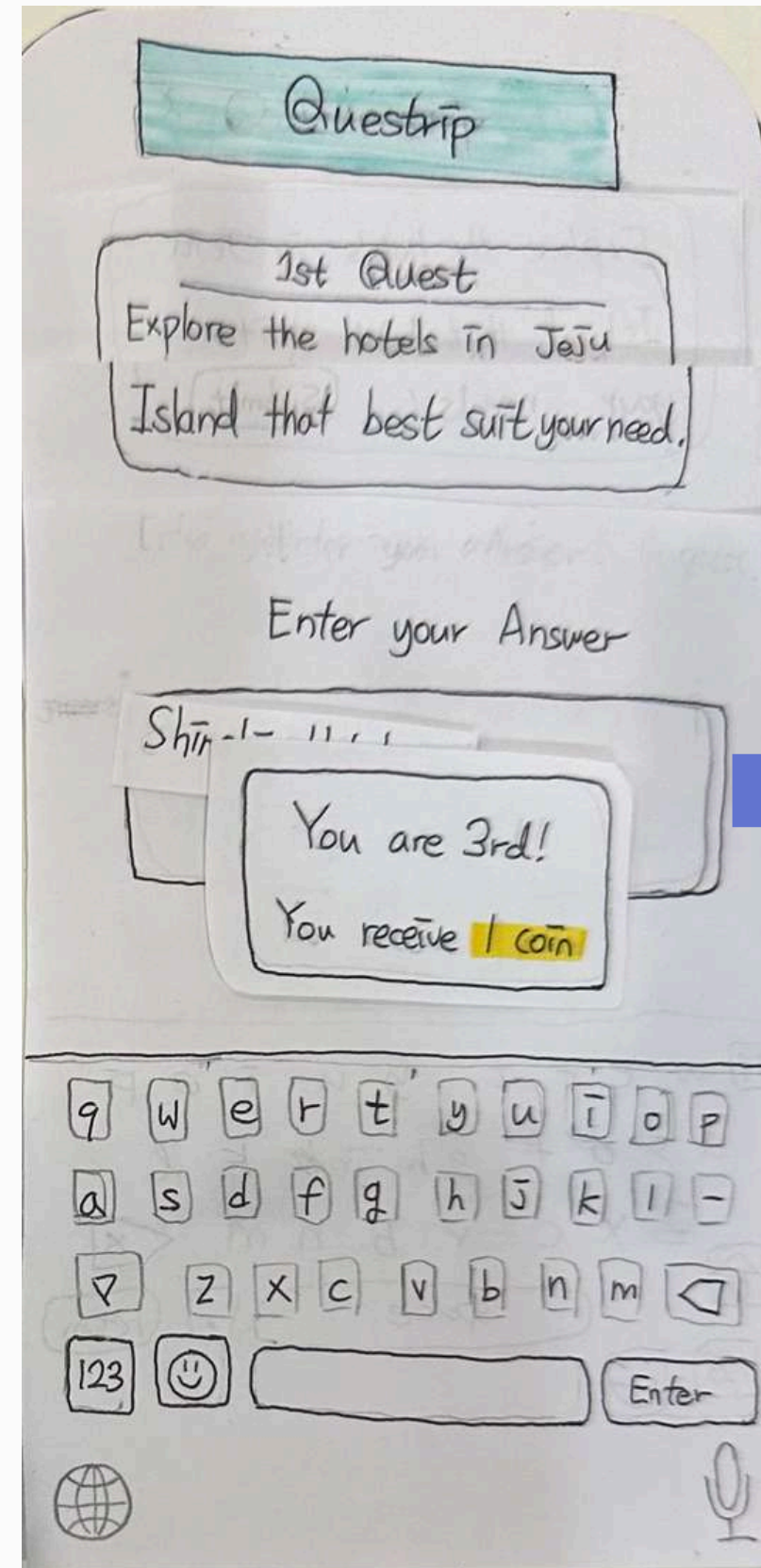
issue : What does “you are third” mean?

The meaning of “you are third” is unclear because it does not clearly communicate the system’s current status or the basis of the feedback. Users may not understand that it indicates their submission order in completing the quest during the voting phase.

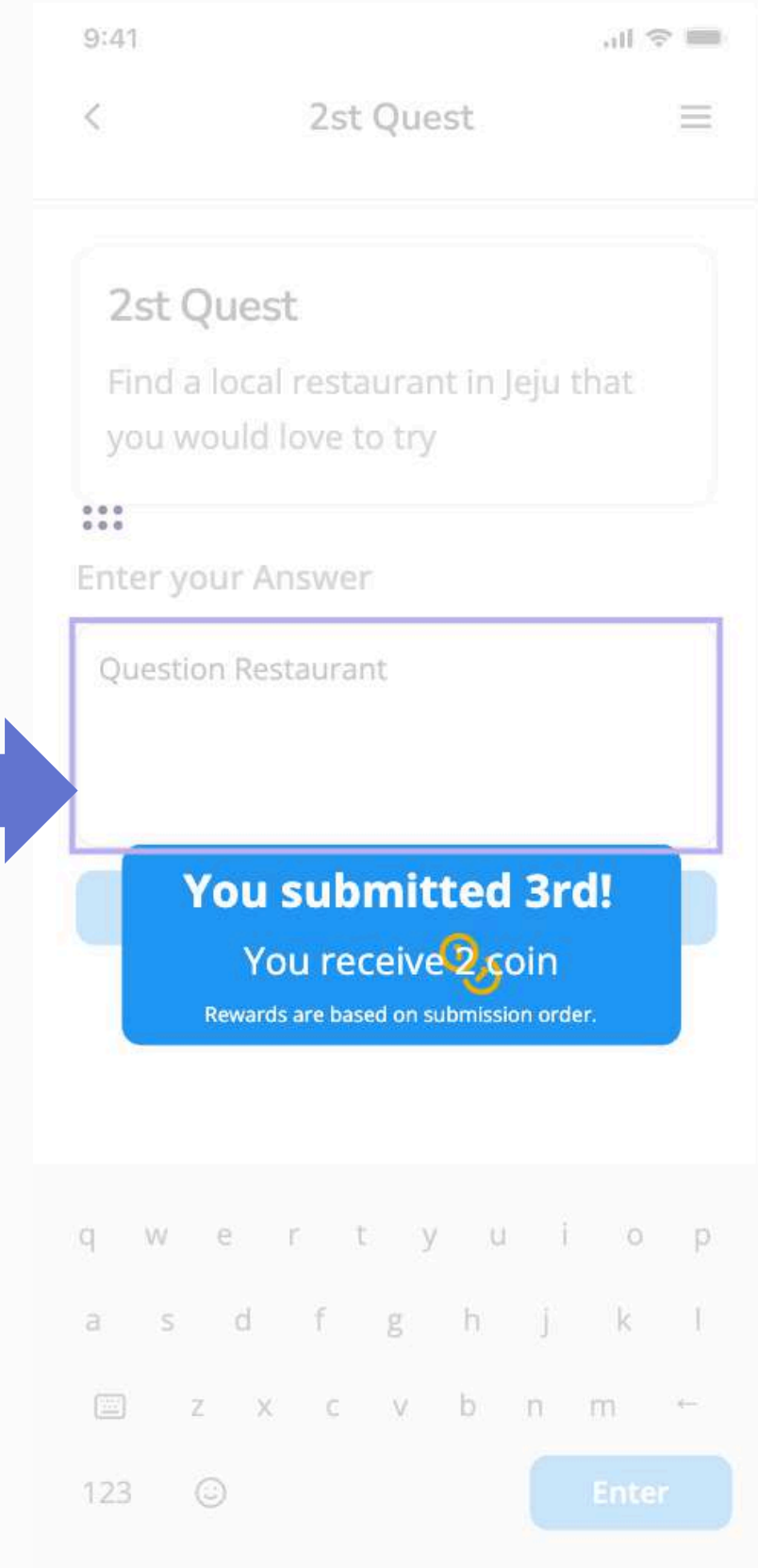
fix :

Since the wording could be confusing, we updated the popup to include clearer and more concise explanations, such as “You submitted 3rd!” and “Rewards are based on submission order.”, to better communicate the submission order and reward mechanism.

Before



After



* VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS

issue: Are voting results shown immediately after submission, or only after all responses are collected?

It is unclear whether voting results are shown immediately after a user submits their response or only after all participants have responded. Although the UI displays a message stating, “Every participation has not been completed. Please wait for vote.”, it does not clearly communicate the current system state—such as how many responses are still pending, when voting will begin, or what the user should expect next. As a result, users may be uncertain about the voting process and its timing.

Before

The sketch illustrates a voting interface. At the top, a green box contains the word "Questrip". Below it, a box titled "1st Quest" contains the text "Explore the hotels in Jeju Island that best suit your need." A progress bar below the quest shows 3 out of 4 segments filled in green, with "3/4" written to its right. Underneath is a table titled "Answer list" and "3/4 Attendees".

	Answer list	3/4 Attendees
1st	Jeju Hotel	by Jason
2nd	Hotel Nobless	by Kevin
3rd	Shinshin Hotel	by You
4th	Waiting...	

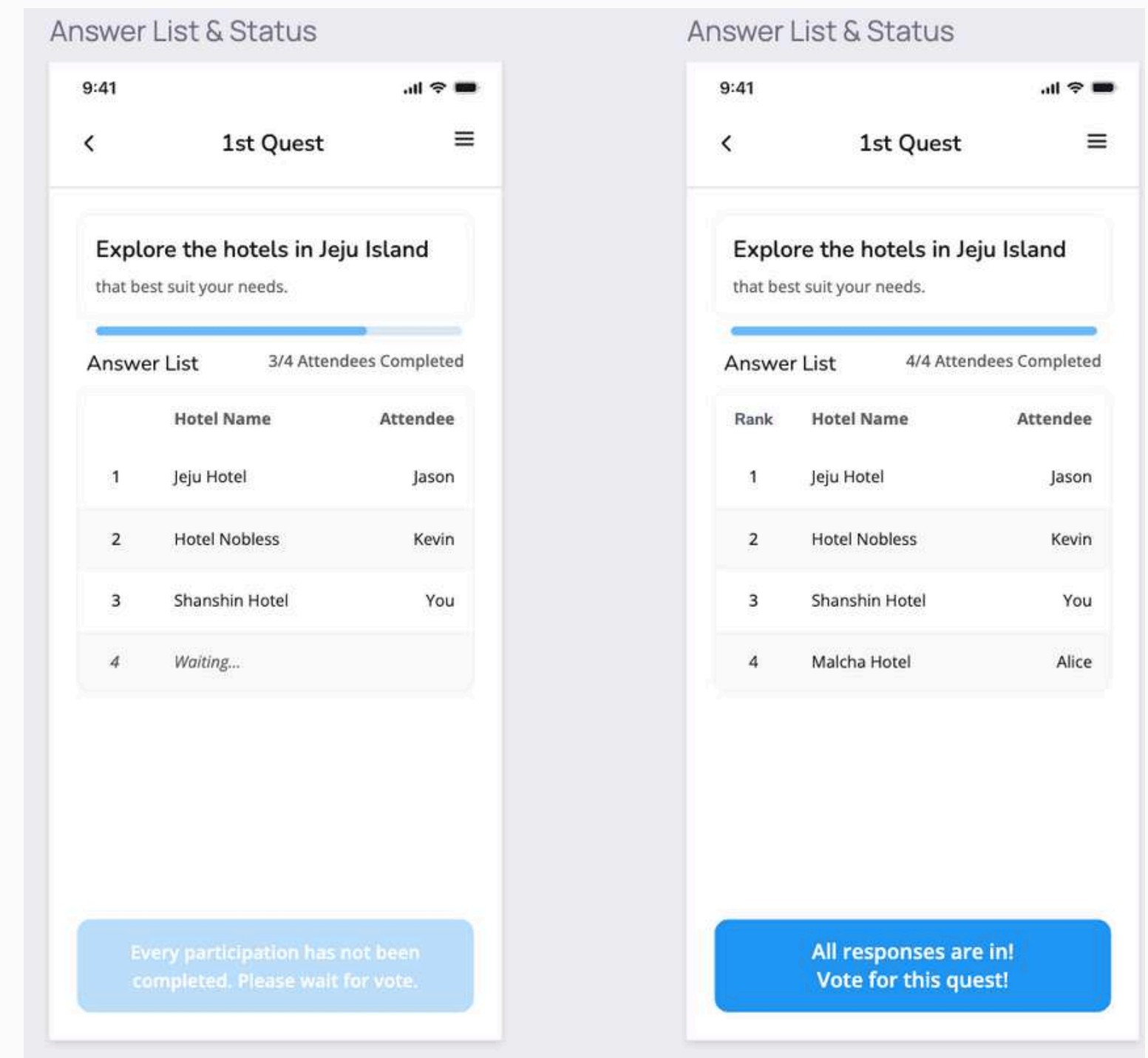
At the bottom, a box contains the message: "Every participation has not been completed. Please wait for vote."

* VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS

fix:

The UI was updated to clearly distinguish between incomplete and completed participation states. When not all attendees have submitted their responses, the screen shows the current progress with bars (e.g., “3/4 Attendees Completed”), displays unanswered entries as “Waiting...”, and visually de-emphasizes the voting action by reducing the button’s opacity to indicate that voting is not yet available. Once participation is complete, the UI transitions to a finalized state, restores the button’s full opacity, and prominently enables the voting action with a clear call to action (“All responses are in! Vote for this quest!”). This visual distinction helps users immediately understand the system status and available actions.

After

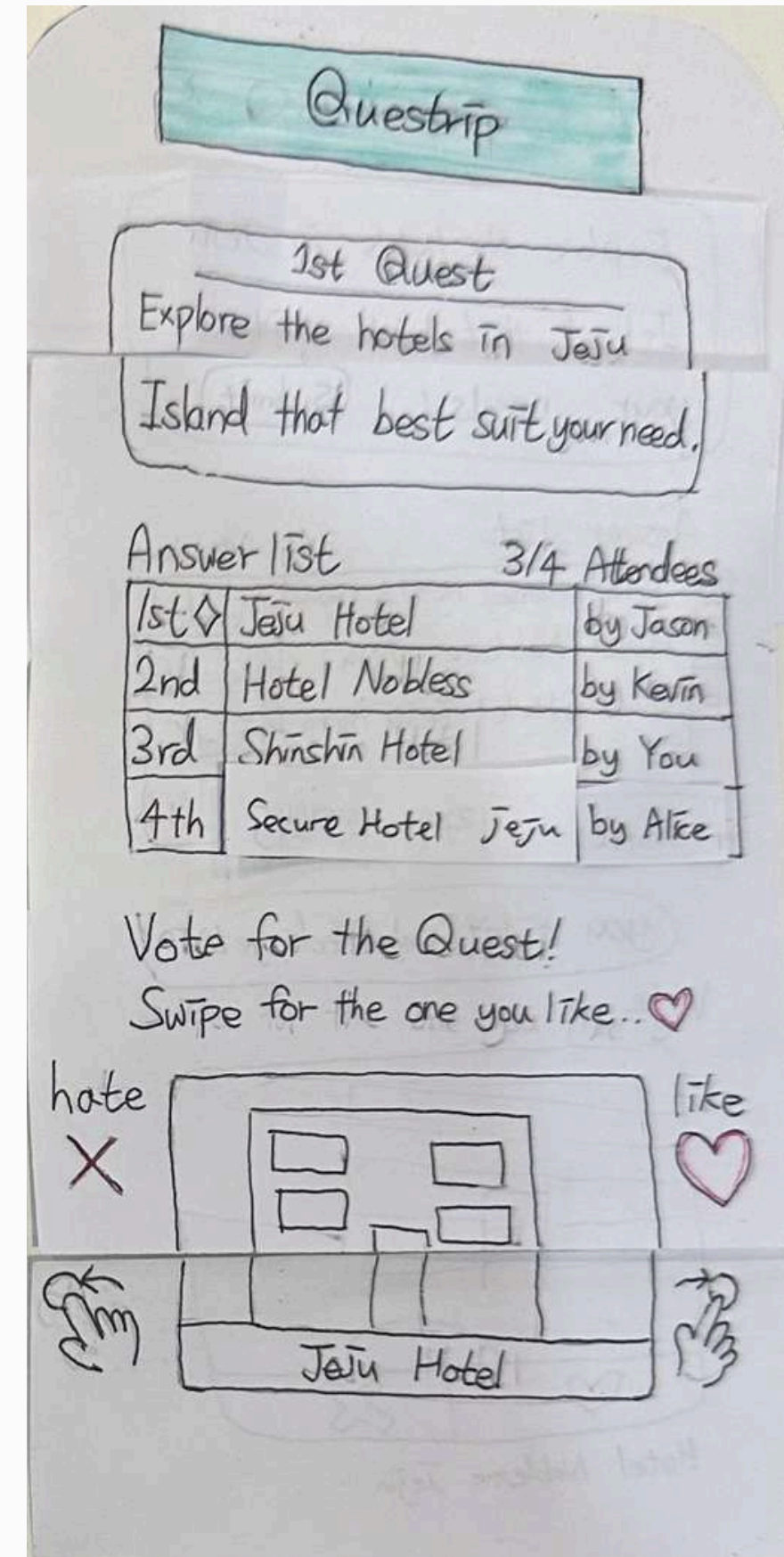


* VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS / ERROR PREVENTION

issue:

It is unclear whether users can vote multiple times or like more than one candidate by swiping. The UI does not clearly communicate the voting rules or constraints, which may lead users to unintentionally cast multiple votes or be uncertain about whether duplicate votes are allowed. This lack of clarity can cause confusion and reduce users' confidence in the fairness of the voting process.

Before

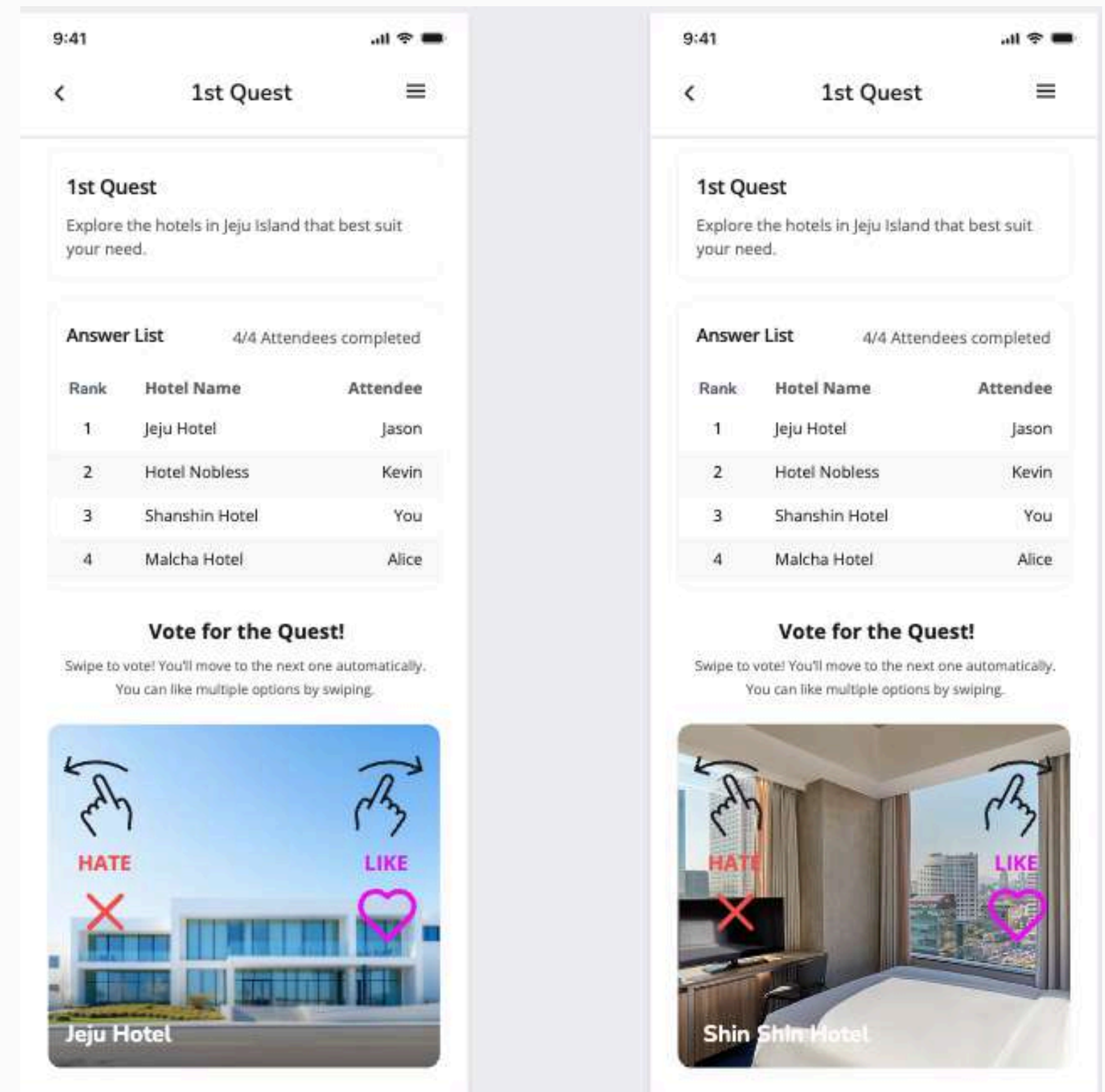


* VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS / ERROR PREVENTION

fix:

The UI was updated to clearly communicate that multiple votes are allowed. An instructional message (“You can like multiple options by swiping.”) explicitly explains the voting rule, reducing ambiguity about duplicate votes. The swipe-based interaction provides immediate feedback and automatically moves to the next option, reinforcing that users can continue voting and helping them understand the voting flow at a glance.

After

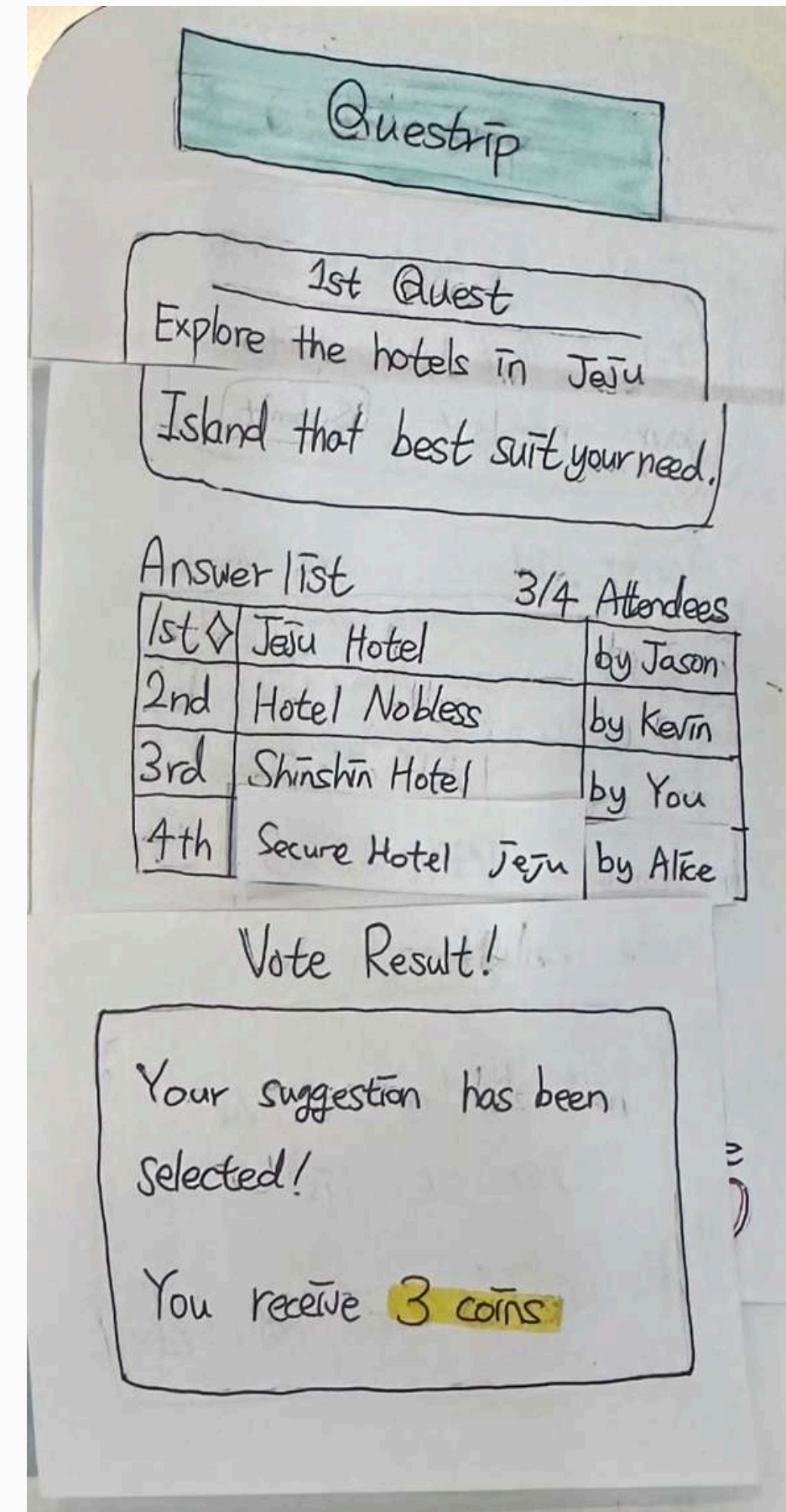


* VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS / CONSISTENCY & STANDARDS

issue:

The voting results are not fully transparent, making it difficult for users to understand how the final outcome is determined. While individual scores are shown, the UI does not sufficiently emphasize the decision logic behind the final winner. In particular, when a tie occurs, users are not clearly informed that a random roulette is used as the tie-breaking mechanism, which can make the result feel unexpected or arbitrary. This lack of clarity may reduce users' trust in the fairness and reliability of the voting process.

Before

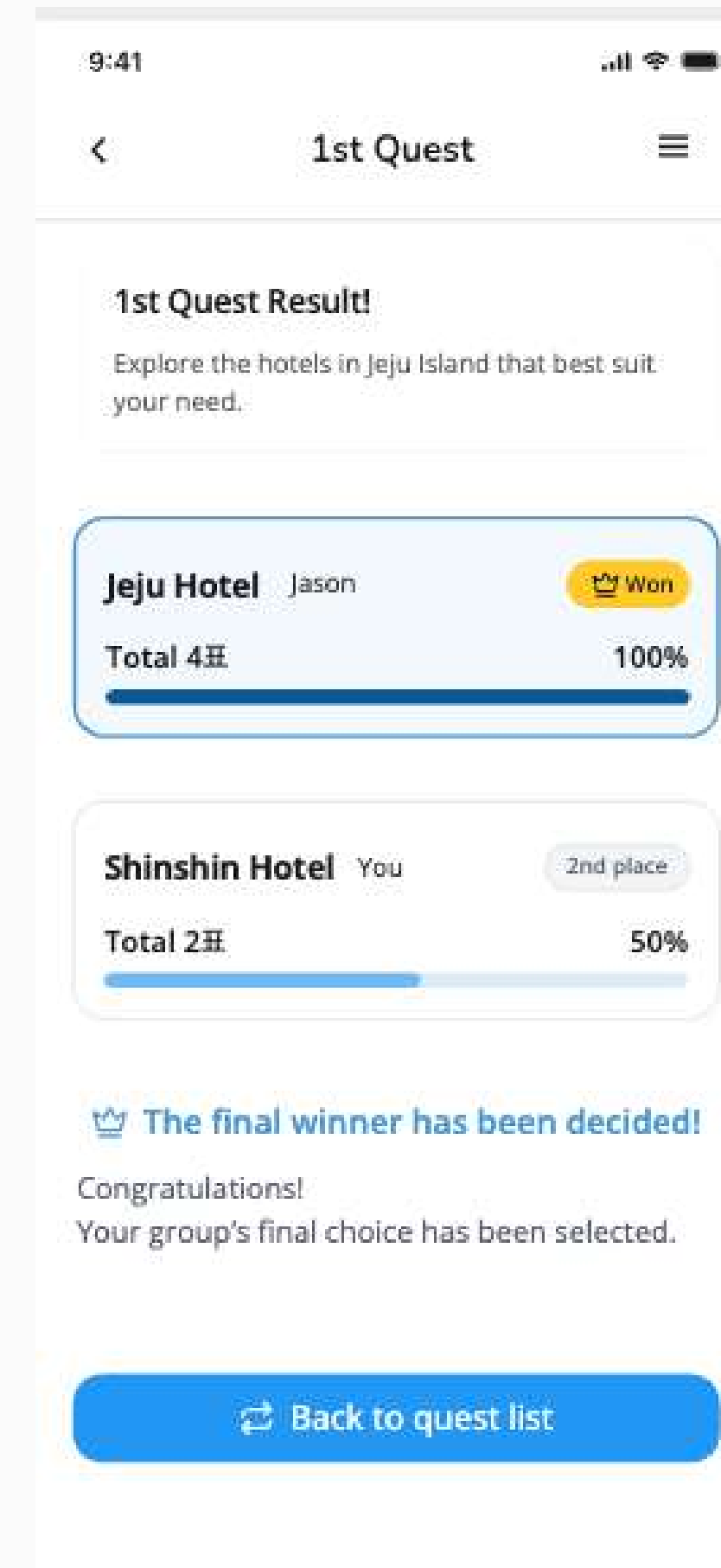


* VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS / CONSISTENCY & STANDARDS

Fix 1: Improving transparency of voting results

To improve transparency, the UI explicitly communicates that ties are resolved using a random roulette. When a tie occurs, a clear visual and textual explanation is provided to show that the winner is selected randomly, helping users understand the system logic and perceive the outcome as fair and rule-based rather than arbitrary.

After

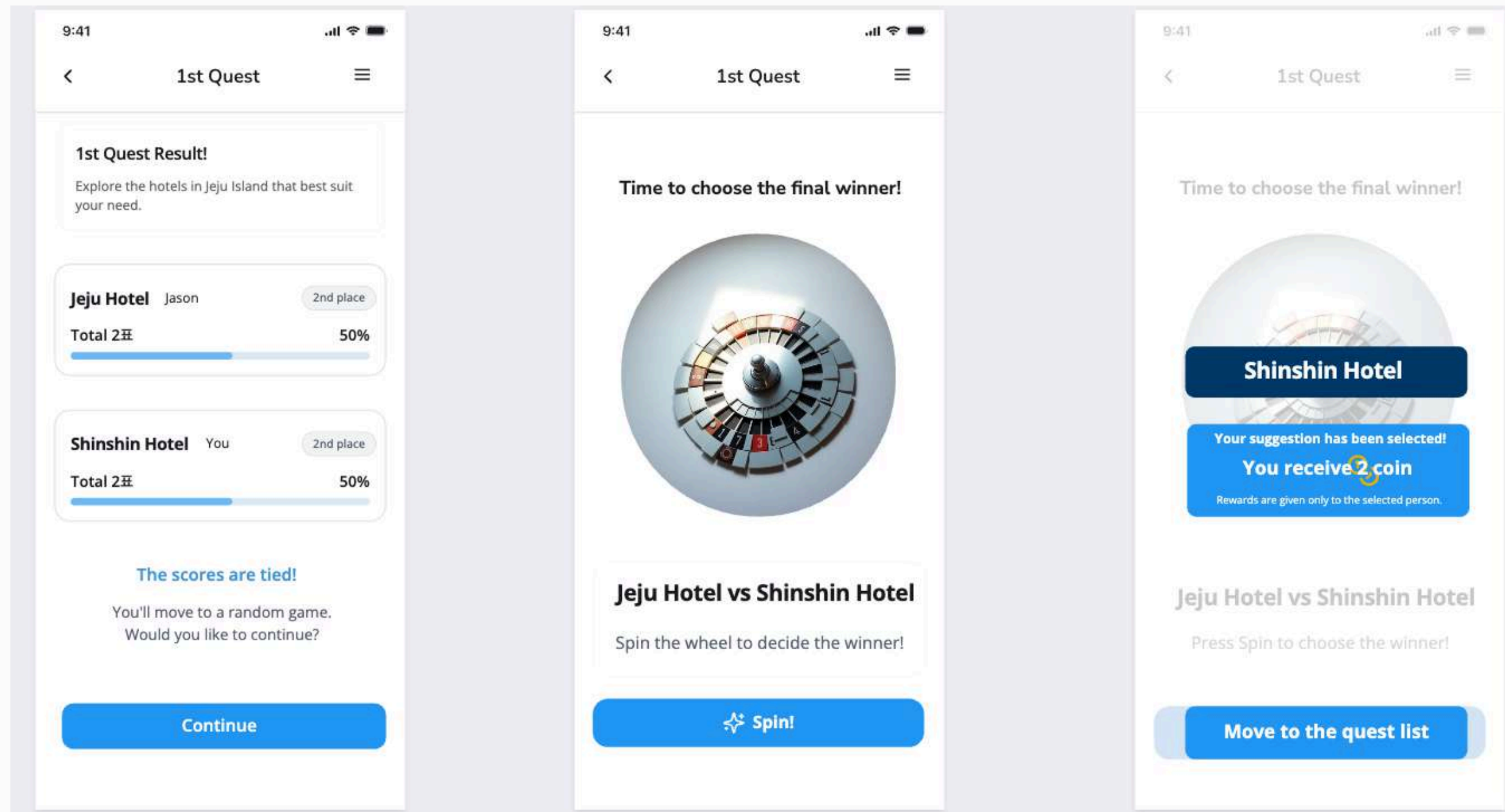


* VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS / CONSISTENCY & STANDARDS

Fix 2: Clarifying tie-breaking behavior

When a tie occurs, the UI now explicitly informs users that a random roulette will be used to determine the final winner. A dedicated transition screen visually presents the roulette-based decision process, along with clear explanatory text, making the tie-breaking logic transparent and predictable. This helps users perceive the outcome as fair, rule-based, and intentionally designed rather than arbitrary.

After



* HEURISTIC EVALUATION – COMPLEX TASK



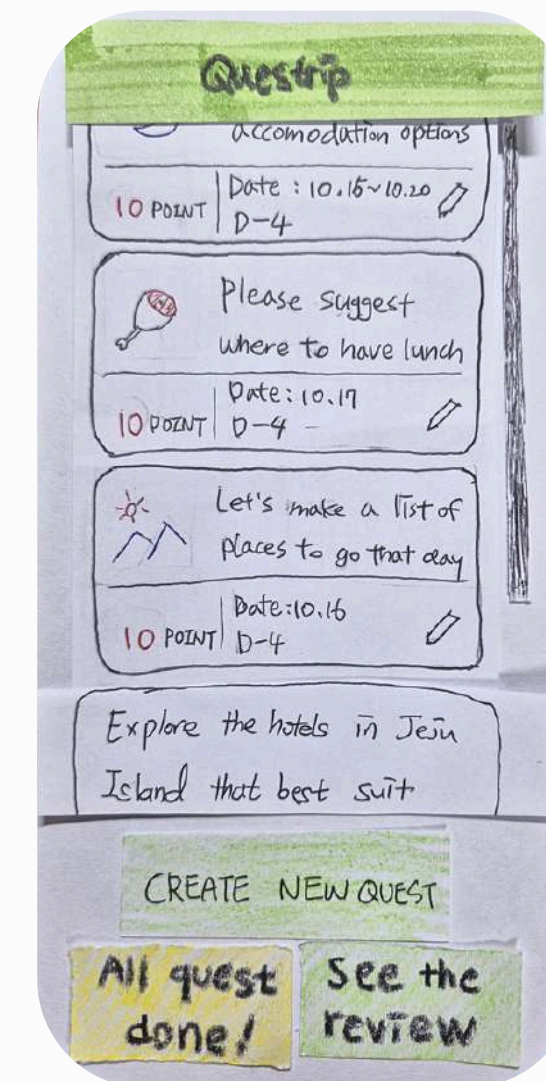
* MATCH BETWEEN SYSTEM AND THE REAL WORLD

issue: Lack of Real-World Context in the Local Review Workflow

The current interface focuses primarily on displaying the final output of local reviews, such as total ratings, revisions, and comments. However, it fails to reflect the real-world mental model of consultation, where a local expert first browses available plans and selects one to review based on relevance or expertise.

By omitting this pre-review context—specifically, the workflow where a local identifies and chooses a plan—the system creates a disconnect between the user's action and the resulting feedback. This lack of transparency makes it difficult for users to understand how the review process is initiated and executed, violating the heuristic of matching system logic with real-world interactions.

Before

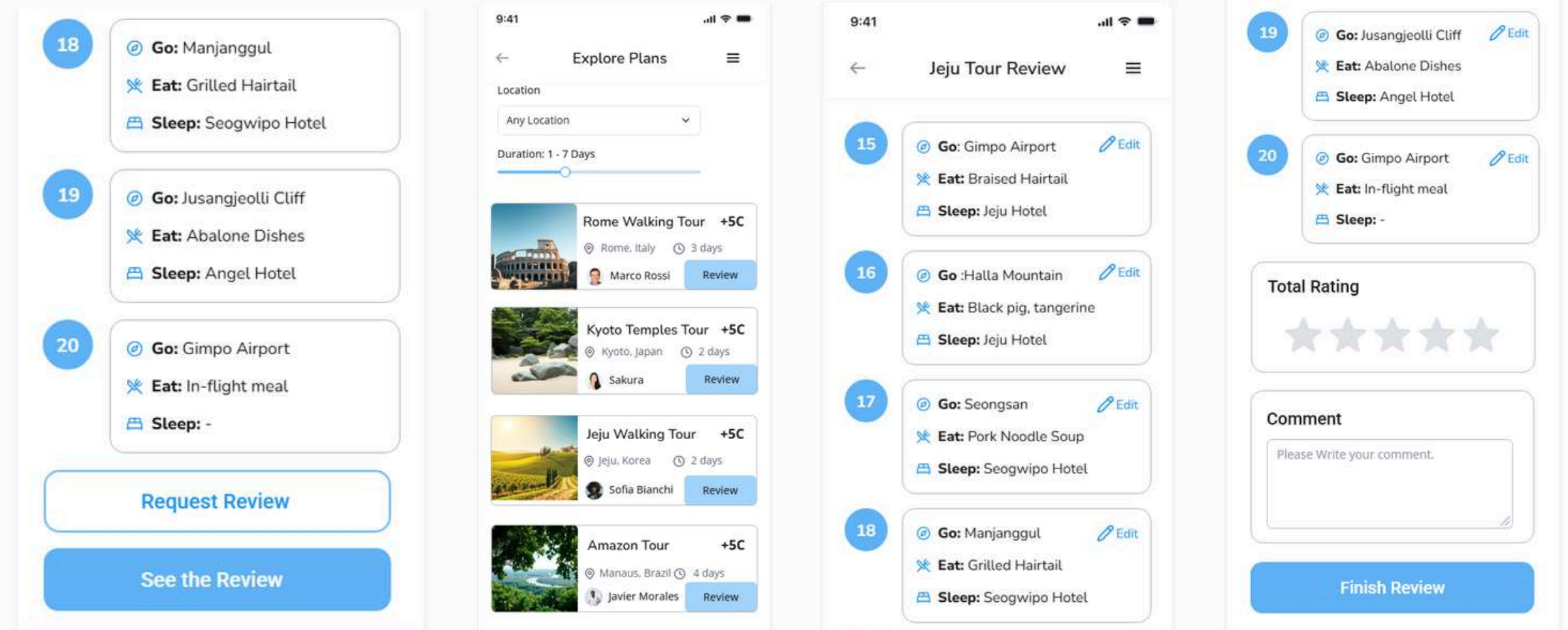


* MATCH BETWEEN SYSTEM AND THE REAL WORLD

fix:

Added a screen for locals to do their own reviews. Locals can choose their own travel plan from the plans of multiple users. Filters can be done by region or date. Feel free to modify what you want to modify in the plan. Leave a horoscope, leave a comment.

After



* VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS

issue: Lack of Immediate Feedback on Reward Acquisition and Opaque Asset Status

Upon completion of the review, the system fails to provide immediate visual feedback confirming that a reward (coins) has been awarded. Users become uncertain whether their actions have been successfully processed or rewards have been granted, which reduces the sense of accomplishment and undermines the reliability of the system.

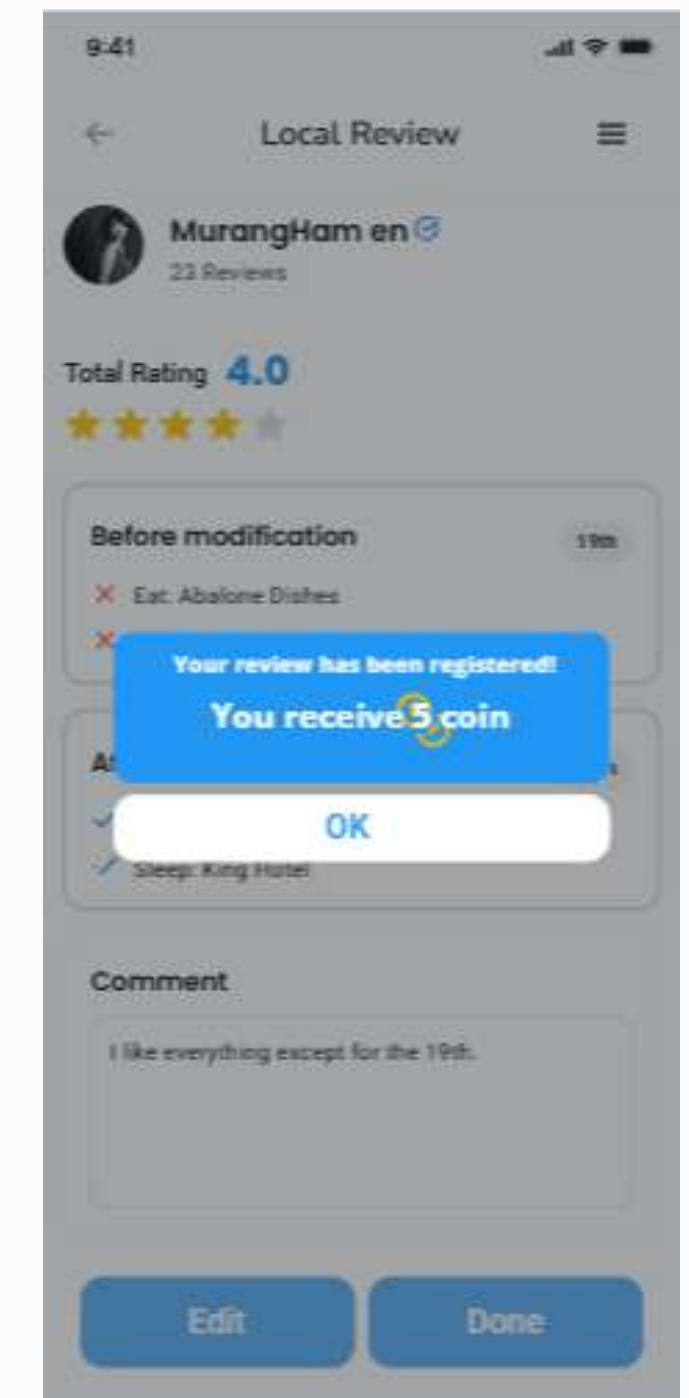
fix: Implementing Real-Time Reward Notifications

Immediately upon completion of the review submission, the results of the action will be clearly guided by toast modals such as 'You have won 5 coins'.

Before



After



* USER CONTROL AND FREEDOM

issue: Lack of Post-Submission Editability and Reversibility

The current workflow is strictly linear; once a local expert submits a review, there is no option to revisit or modify their input. This absence of a "correction loop" creates user anxiety regarding potential errors (e.g., typos, misinformation) and violates the heuristic of providing users with control to undo unwanted actions or refine their content.

Before

The sketch illustrates a linear review process on a piece of paper titled 'Questrip'. It shows a user profile for 'MurangHamen' with 23 reviews and a 4.0 rating (4 stars). The 'Recommendation' section shows a sequence of choices: first, 'Eat: Abalone Dishes' and 'Sleep: Angel Hotel' are crossed out with red X's; then, an arrow points down to a second box where 'Eat: Praw fish' and 'Sleep: King Hotel' are checked with green checkmarks. A 'Comment' box at the bottom contains the text: 'Overall, it's good. But the Angel Hotel on the 19th has a bad reviews.' and a thumbs-up icon.

Questrip

Local Review

MurangHamen Accumulated Reviews: 23

Total Rating 4.0

Recommendation

~~19~~ ~~Eat: Abalone Dishes~~
~~Sleep: Angel Hotel~~

↓

19 ☒ Eat: Praw fish
☒ Sleep: King Hotel

Comment

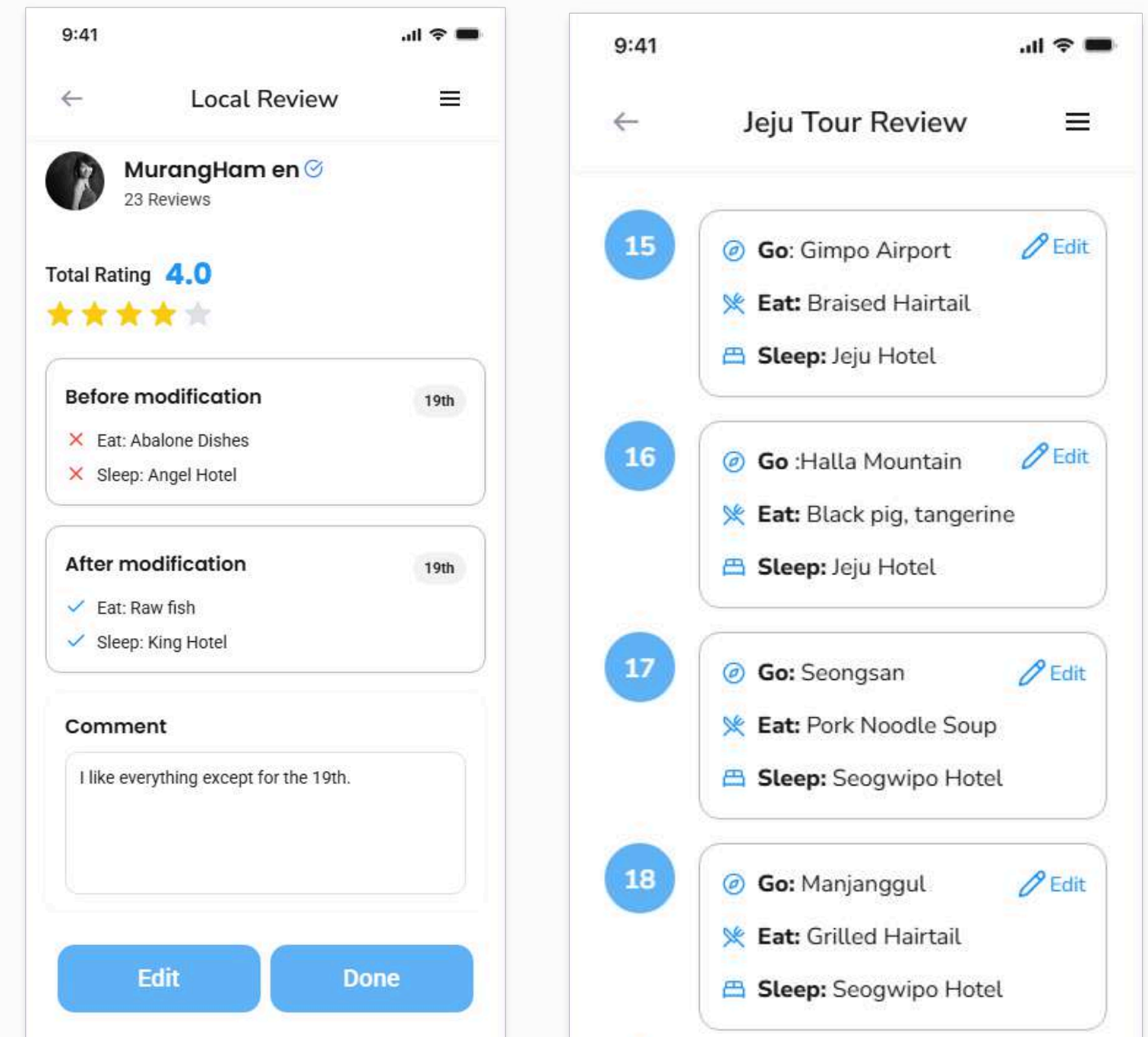
Overall, it's good. But the Angel Hotel on the 19th has a bad reviews.

* USER CONTROL AND FREEDOM

fix: Implementing 'Edit' Functionality for Error Recovery and Refinement

We introduced an 'Edit' button on the final review summary screen, allowing users to return to the drafting phase at any time. This non-destructive workflow empowers users to correct mistakes or refine their advice even after the initial completion, thereby ensuring user freedom and reducing the cognitive load associated with "perfect" submission.

After



* RECOGNITION RATHER THAN RECALL

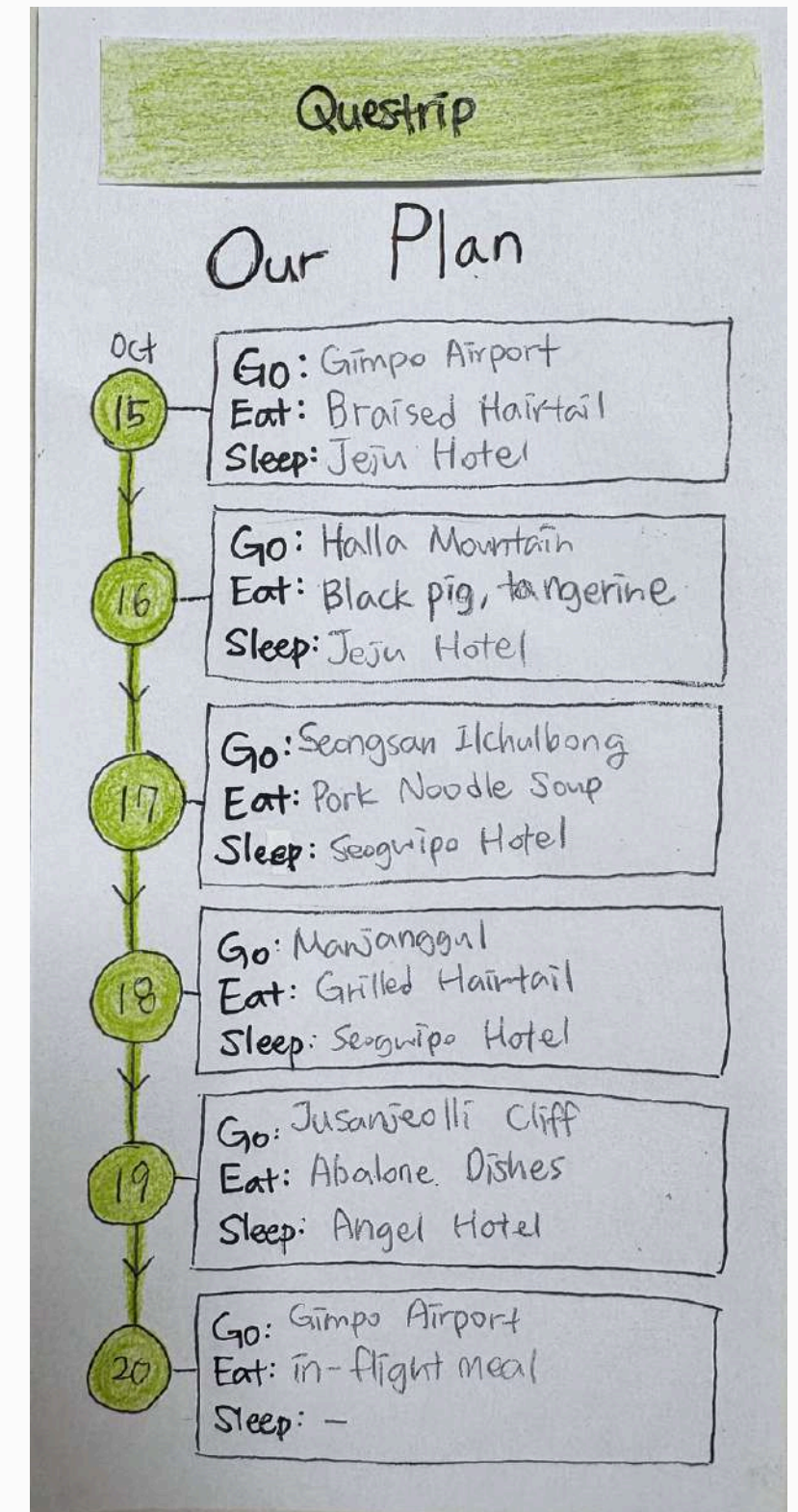
issue1: Increased Cognitive Load Due to Lack of Contextual Indicators

In the previous design, the plan detail view utilized generic headers (e.g., "Our Plan") that failed to provide specific context. For users managing multiple trip itineraries simultaneously, this ambiguity forces them to rely on memory (Recall) or navigate backward to verify which destination they are currently viewing. This absence of persistent context increases cognitive load and disrupts the user's flow.

issue2: High Interaction Cost Caused by Excessive Navigation Depth and Hidden Features

The previous information architecture buried critical features—specifically the final travel plan and review view—under multiple layers of navigation. Users were forced to traverse a cumbersome path (Home > Quest Screen > Plan/Review Details) to access their core data. This deep nesting increases the interaction cost and friction, requiring users to recall a complex retrieval path rather than offering direct access to frequently used information.

Before

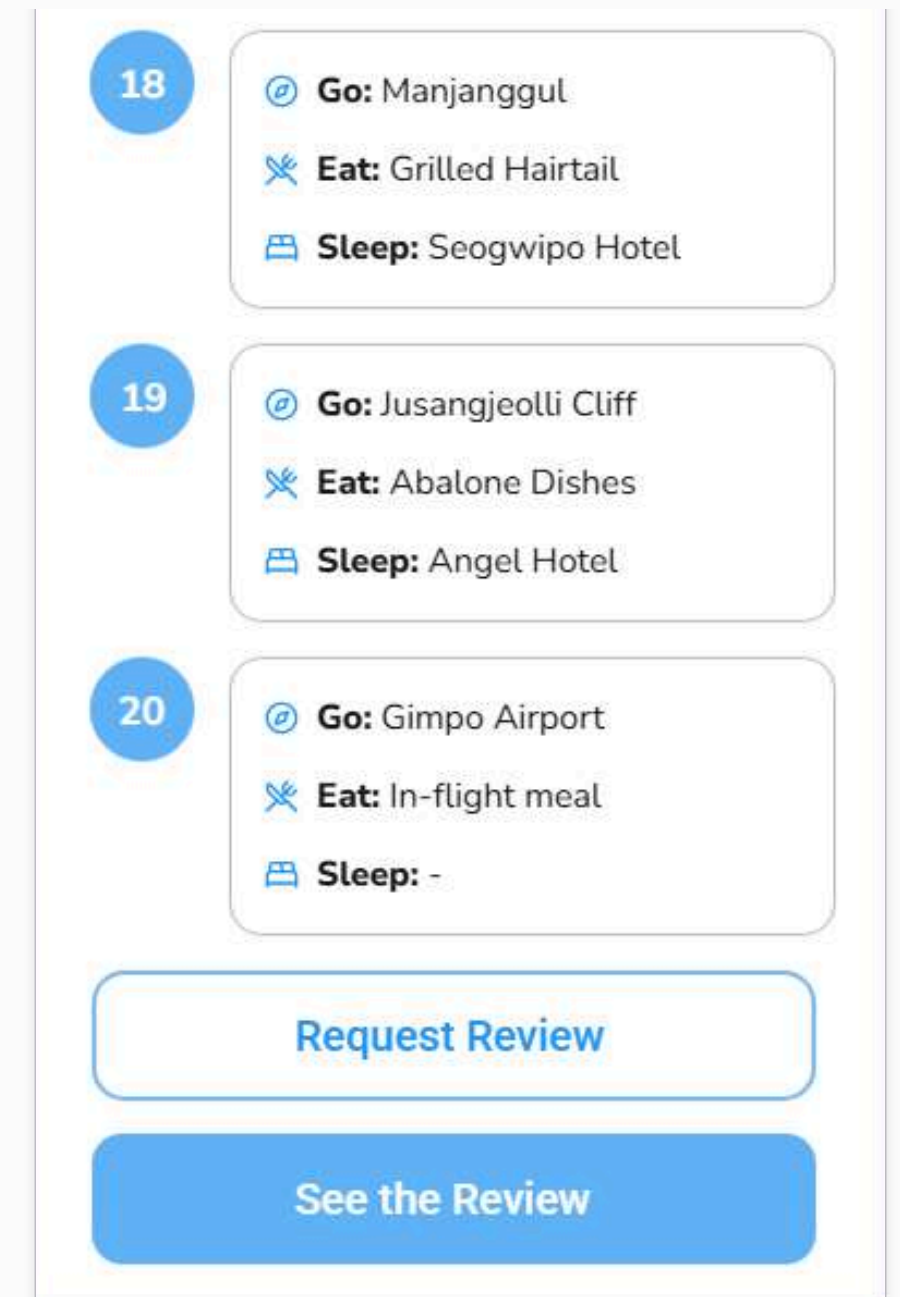
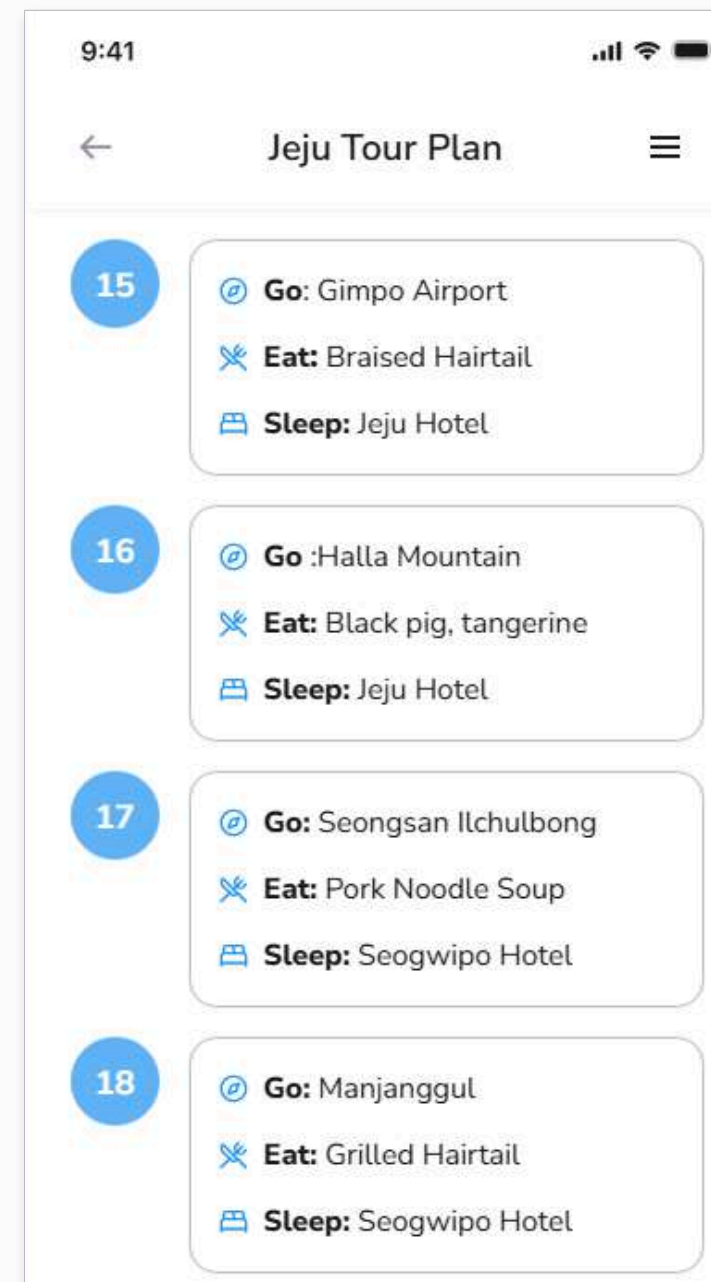


* RECOGNITION RATHER THAN RECALL

After

fix1: Enhancing Visibility via Explicit and Persistent Page Titles

We implemented a specific, persistent header at the top of the interface (e.g., "Jeju Tour Plan") that clearly identifies the current itinerary. By making this critical context strictly visible, the design allows users to instantly recognize the subject matter without needing to retrieve information from memory. This change minimizes navigation errors and ensures users always know their location within the app's hierarchy.



* RECOGNITION RATHER THAN RECALL

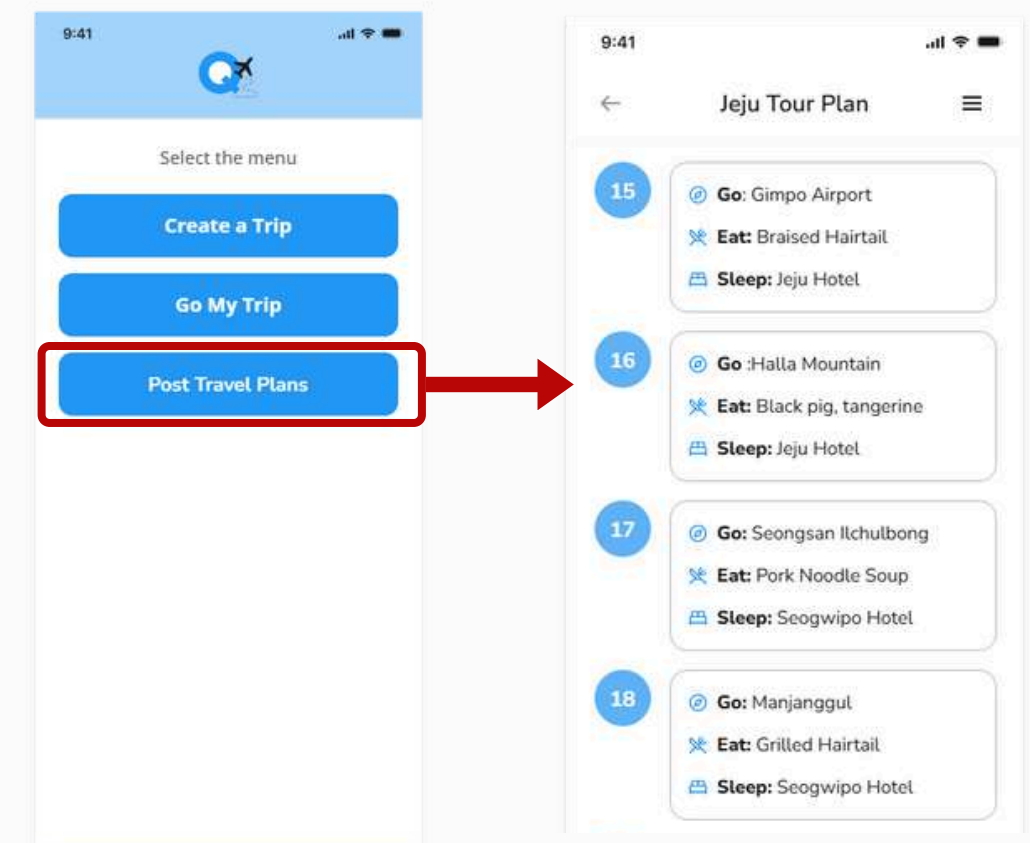
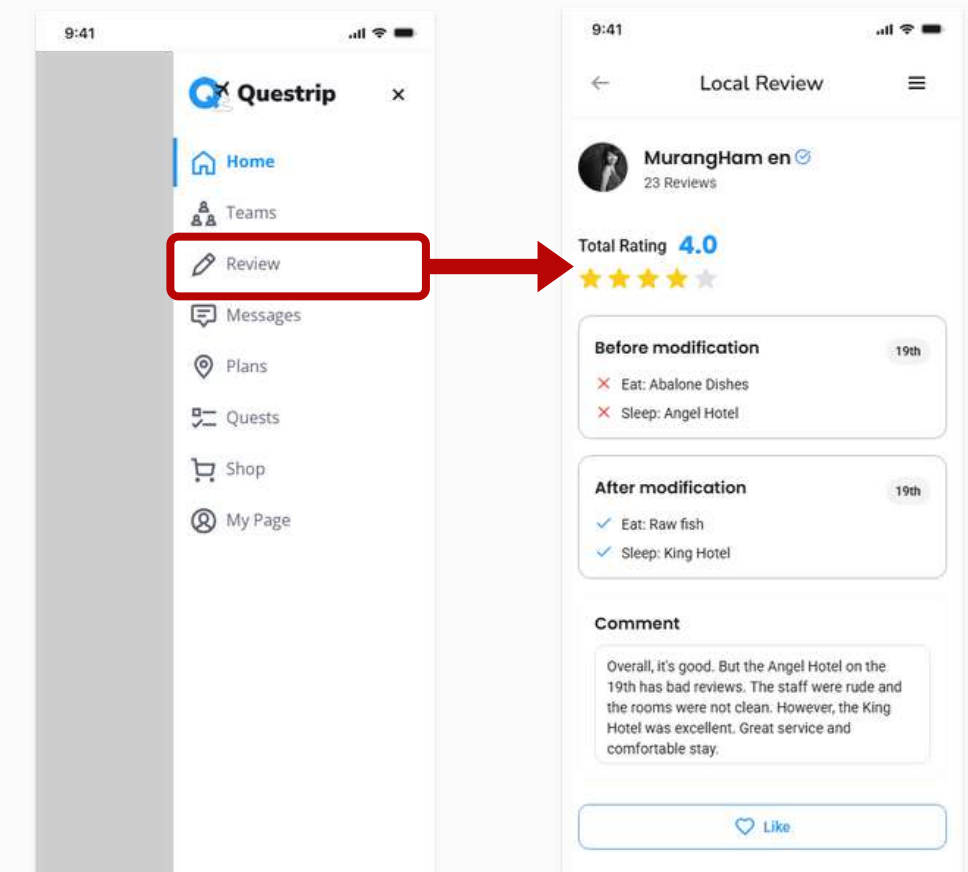
fix2: Flattening Information Architecture via Sidebar for Instant Accessibility

'Travel Plan' and 'Review' features were upgraded from overlapping submenus to global sidebar to reconstruct navigation. This flattened the hierarchy, allowing the user instant access to the itinerary from any screen without having to go through the 'quest' flow.

I also made a button to check my final plan right on the home screen.

These changes significantly reduce memory load and place key features in locations that users can easily recognize and select, increasing searchability.

After



*** MORE
REFINED
PROTOTYPE**



ISSUE

VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS

It's unclear where system-related information—such as coin rewards—is being accumulated.

HELP AND DOCUMENTATION

- Lack of explanation of the reward system (how to earn and use coins)
- Users may find it hard to understand how to use the app right away because there is no initial guide.

CONSISTENCY AND STANDARDS

The app logo at the top differs from screen to screen.

PROFESSOR'S FEEDBACK

- What are rewards for? How do you use it? Where in the app can you check all the rewards you've collected so far?

FIX

* CREATED A REPRESENTATIVE LOGO & UNIFIED PAGE LAYOUT

We designed a single representative logo and standardized shared UI elements (e.g., the top bar) across all pages to improve visual consistency.

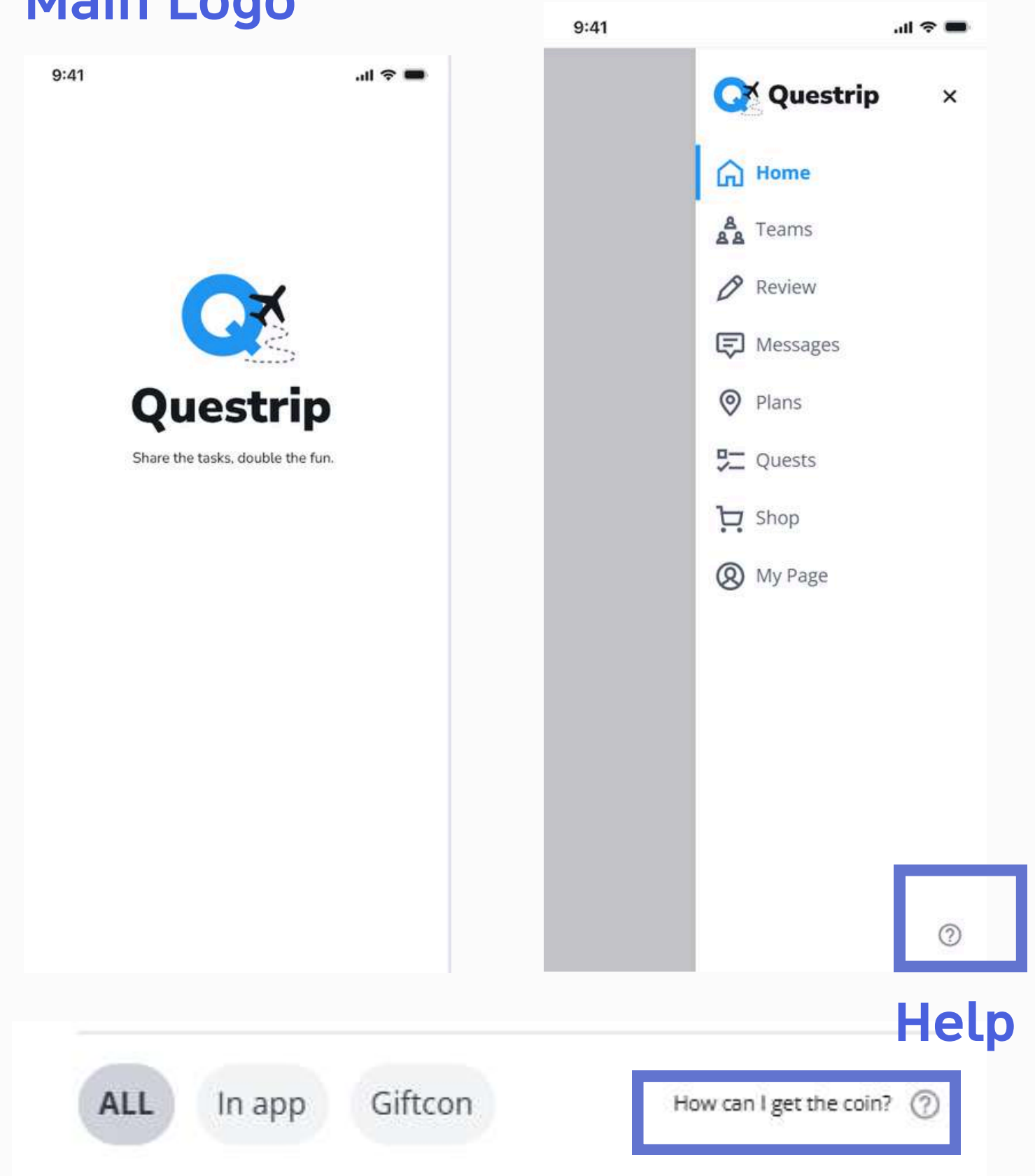
* ADDED HELP/GUIDE ICONS

We placed help icons on screens such as the navigation bar and the shop, allowing users to access guidance whenever needed.

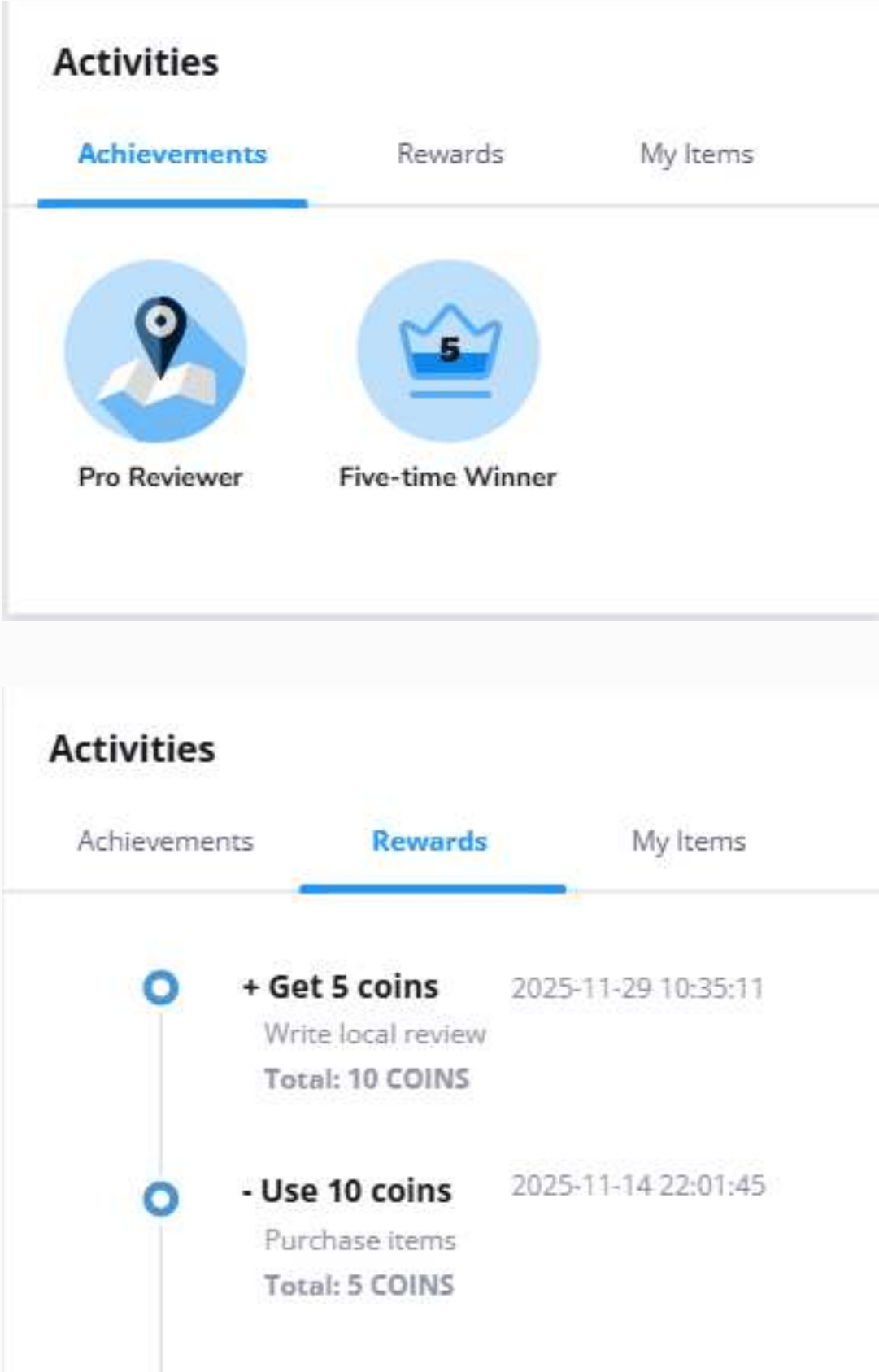
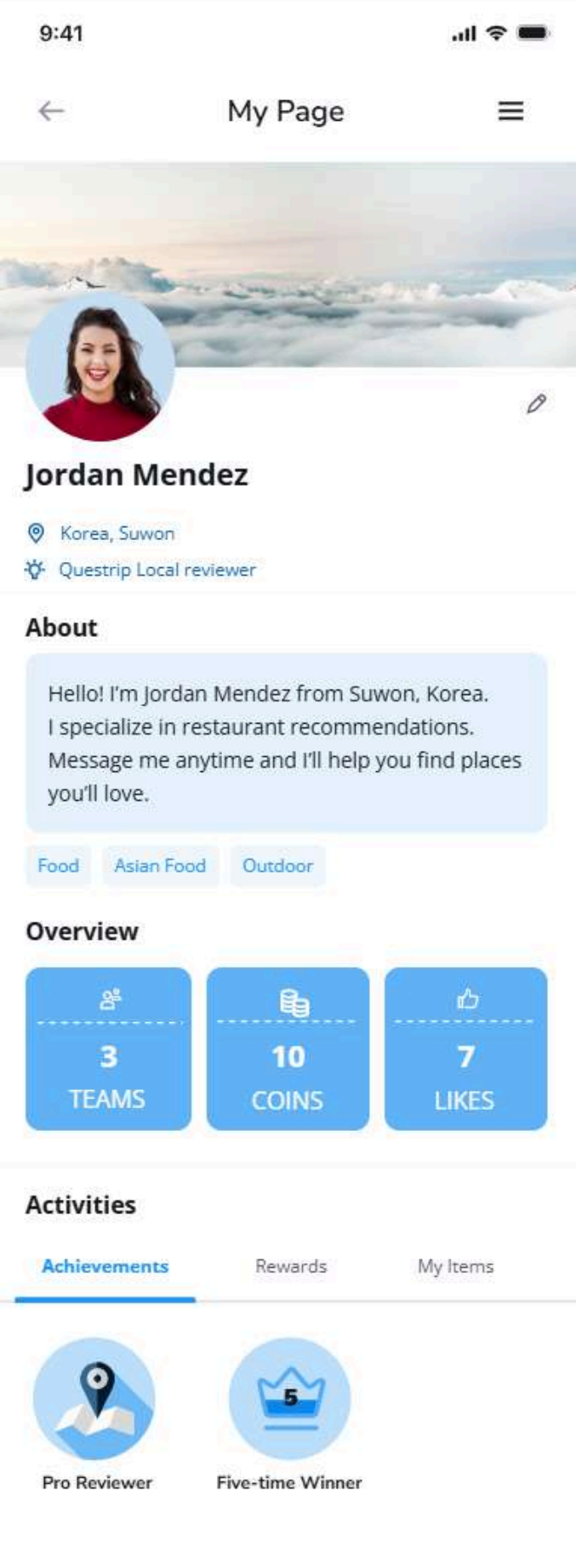
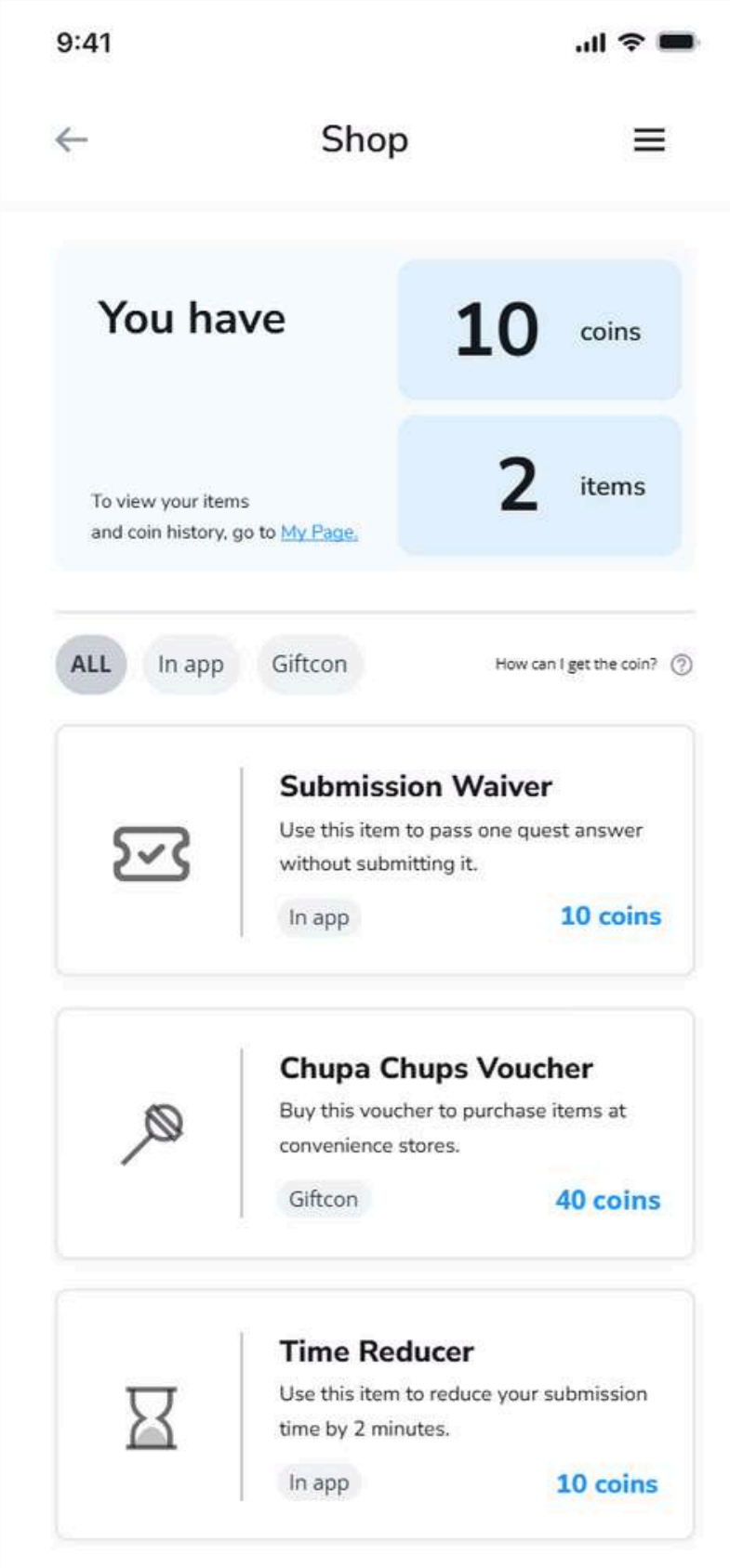
* CREATED MYPAGE & SHOP PAGES

We added a My Page and a Shop page so users can view their coin balance and spend coins easily.

Main Logo



FIX





THANKS

QUESTRIP, TEAM 8